

Models Authoring Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **data shapes that cross boundaries or are shown clearly to users or other systems**.

This guide is about **what information is carried, how it is grouped, and what it represents**.

What belongs here

- request payload shapes
- event payload shapes
- read models shown to users
- shared data transfer objects
- reusable fields or parameters when they have stable meaning

What does not belong here

- business concept meaning by itself
- UI flow behavior
- purely internal technical structures with no cross-boundary value

Core things to capture

- what information package exists
- what it is used for
- what main fields it contains
- what concept or business meaning it represents
- who sends or receives it

Core relationships to capture

- model -> concept represented
- model -> operation using it
- model -> screen or view showing it

- field -> business meaning

Modus operandi

Think in information bundles:

1. identify what data crosses a boundary or is shown together
2. describe its purpose
3. list the important fields in business language
4. explain what concept it represents
5. note who produces and consumes it

Prompt set

- what information travels together?
- why does this shape exist?
- who sends it and who receives it?
- what business concept does it represent?
- which fields are essential to understand the payload?

Free-text intake template

- **Model name:**
- **Purpose:**
- **Produced by / consumed by:**
- **Represents:**
- **Important fields:**
- **Where it is displayed or used:**

Worked example

- Leave Request Summary model is used on the employee dashboard and manager review page
- It represents a leave request and includes employee name, dates, status, and decision summary

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into reusable data models and field definitions linked to operations, concepts, and views.

Common mistakes

- listing every storage column instead of the meaningful data shape
- omitting the purpose of the model
- describing fields with technical names only
- forgetting what concept the model represents